

ANSWER KEY

Powers to Arrest — BSIS Certification Course

Instructor & Company Copy — Retain Securely

55 Questions | Passing Score: 100% | BPC §7583.7 | PPO #122729

MACCESS INC.

BSIS-Authorized Training Provider | June 27, 2026

QUICK REFERENCE — ALL ANSWERS

55 Questions | Pass: 100%

Q1	B	Q2	D	Q3	B	Q4	C	Q5	C
Q6	C	Q7	B	Q8	B	Q9	D	Q10	C
Q11	B	Q12	C	Q13	C	Q14	A	Q15	B
Q16	B	Q17	C	Q18	C	Q19	B	Q20	D
Q21	B	Q22	B	Q23	C	Q24	C	Q25	C
Q26	D	Q27	D	Q28	B	Q29	C	Q30	C

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Module 1 — Legal Framework

BPC §7583.7

Which California law requires security guards to complete Power to Arrest training before receiving a guard card?

A. California Penal Code §837

✓ B. Business and Professions Code §7583.7

C. Title 16 California Code of Regulations §643

D. California Penal Code §847

B

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Module 1 — Legal Framework

BPC §7583.7

What score must a student achieve on the BSIS Power to Arrest exam to receive a Certificate of Completion?

A. 70%

B. 80%

C. 90%

✓ D. 100%

D

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Module 1 — Legal Framework

DCA PTA Manual July 2023

Which manual is required for Power to Arrest and Appropriate Use of Force training?

A. California Security Officer Handbook 2022

✓ B. DCA Power to Arrest and Appropriate Use of Force Training Manual 2023

C. BSIS Regulatory Guide Title 16

D. California Penal Code Annotated

B

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Module 1 — Legal Framework

BPC §7583.7

As a security guard in California, your arrest authority comes from the same law that applies to:

A. A sworn police officer

B. A licensed investigator

✓ C. A private citizen

D. A government contractor

C

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Module 1 — Legal Framework

SB 652 (Jan 1 2026)

Under SB 652 effective January 1, 2026, the full 8-hour PTA + AUF training must be delivered by:

A. Any two BSIS-approved providers

B. The applicant's employer only

✓ C. A single BSIS-approved course provider

D. An online provider plus a separate in-person facility

C

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Module 1 — Legal Framework

SB 652 | BPC §7583.6

How long before a guard card application must the 8-hour PTA/AUF training be completed?

A. 30 days

B. 3 months

✓ C. 6 months

D. 1 year

C

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Module 1 — Legal Framework

BPC §7583.7

MACCESS INC. is authorized to deliver this certification as a licensed:

- A. Peace officer agency
- C. Federal security contractor

- ✓ **B. Private Patrol Operator — PPO #122729**
- D. BSIS examination center

B

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Module 2 — Citizen Arrest Authority (PC §837)

PC §837

California Penal Code §837 lists how many conditions under which a private person may make a citizen's arrest?

- A. Two
- C. Four

- ✓ **B. Three**
- D. Five

B

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Module 2 — Citizen Arrest Authority (PC §837)

PC §837(1)

Under PC §837(1), a security guard may make a citizen's arrest when a public offense is:

- A. Reported by a witness
- C. Captured on CCTV footage only

- B. Suspected based on prior criminal history
- ✓ **D. Committed or attempted in the guard's direct presence**

D

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Module 2 — Citizen Arrest Authority (PC §837)

PC §837(2)

Under PC §837(2), a guard may arrest someone for a felony not committed in their presence if:

- A. A supervisor authorizes the arrest
- B. The guard has a hunch the person is guilty
- ✓ C. The guard knows the person committed the felony
- D. The property owner requests the arrest

C

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Module 2 — Citizen Arrest Authority (PC §837)

PC §837(3)

PC §837(3) requires that for a reasonable-cause felony arrest, a felony must:

- A. Be suspected but not confirmed
- ✓ B. Have actually been committed in fact
- C. Have been reported to police first
- D. Involve violence or weapons

B

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Module 2 — Citizen Arrest Authority (PC §837)

PC §837

A guard receives a report that someone stole from the store yesterday but did not witness it. Can they make a citizen's arrest for this misdemeanor?

- A. Yes — any theft justifies arrest
- B. Yes — with supervisor approval
- ✓ C. No — misdemeanor arrest requires personal observation
- D. No — only police can arrest for theft

C

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Module 2 — Citizen Arrest Authority (PC §837)

PC §837(3)

Which PC §837 arrest condition carries the greatest liability risk if used incorrectly?

- A. §837(1) — offense in presence
✓ C. §837(3) — reasonable cause for felony
B. §837(2) — felony by that person
D. All conditions carry equal risk

C

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Module 2 — Citizen Arrest Authority (PC §837)

PC §837

A guard witnesses a person vandalizing a car. Which PC §837 condition applies?

- ✓ A. §837(1) — public offense in presence
B. §837(2) — felony by the person
C. §837(3) — reasonable cause
D. None — vandalism cannot justify arrest

A

15

Module 2 — Citizen Arrest Authority (PC §837)

PC §837

'Reasonable cause' under PC §837 means:

- A. A gut feeling the person looks suspicious
✓ B. Objective facts supporting a belief the person committed a felony
C. A witness statement alone
D. Prior criminal history of the person

B

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Module 2 — Citizen Arrest Authority (PC §837)

PC §490.5

The Shopkeeper's Privilege under PC §490.5 allows detention for shoplifting when there is:

- A. Suspicion based on appearance
- ✓ B. Probable cause based on direct observation
- C. A manager's verbal authorization
- D. A description matching prior reports

B

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Module 3 — Limitations & Prohibited Actions

PC §538d

A security guard who represents themselves as a police officer may face criminal charges under:

- A. PC §602
- B. BPC §480
- ✓ C. PC §538d
- D. PC §836

C

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Module 3 — Limitations & Prohibited Actions

PC §837 | 4th Amendment

A security guard's search authority during a lawful detention is limited to:

- A. A full search of the person's clothing and bags
- B. An unlimited search on private property
- ✓ C. A safety pat-down for weapons only
- D. Any search authorized by the property owner

C

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Module 3 — Limitations & Prohibited Actions

PC §236 | PC §847

Courts generally view a detention lasting more than ____ minutes without police notification as potentially false imprisonment.

A. 5–10 minutes

✓ B. 20–30 minutes

C. 45–60 minutes

D. 2 hours

B

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Module 3 — Limitations & Prohibited Actions

PC §837

A security guard's arrest authority extends only to:

A. Anywhere in the city they are assigned

B. The entire county

C. Statewide under their BSIS license

✓ D. The property they are hired to protect

D

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Module 3 — Limitations & Prohibited Actions

PC §236

Detaining someone without a lawful basis under PC §837 constitutes:

A. Lawful preventive detention

✓ B. False imprisonment

C. Authorized security action

D. Investigative detention

B

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Module 3 — Limitations & Prohibited Actions

PC §242

A security guard handcuffs someone without a lawful basis for arrest. This could constitute:

- A. Lawful restraint under BPC §7583.7
C. Authorized preventive security action

- ✓ B. False imprisonment and assault under California law
D. A civil matter only

B

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Module 3 — Limitations & Prohibited Actions

PC §837

A guard detains a person based solely on race and a vague manager concern. This detention is:

- A. Lawful under employer authority
✓ C. Unlawful — race alone is never reasonable suspicion

- B. Lawful with signed manager form
D. Lawful for 30 minutes pending investigation

C

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Module 4 — Security vs. Law Enforcement

PC §830

California peace officer authority is derived from:

- A. Penal Code §837
✓ C. Penal Code §830 et seq.

- B. Business and Professions Code §7583.7
D. Title 16 CCR §643

C

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Module 4 — Security vs. Law Enforcement

PC §837 | PC §830

Which power does a peace officer have that a security guard does NOT?

- A. The power to observe and report
- ✓ C. The power to conduct lawful searches based on probable cause through investigation
- B. The power to make a citizen's arrest
- D. The power to ask a person their name

C

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Module 4 — Security vs. Law Enforcement

PC §847

After making a citizen's arrest, a security guard must deliver the person to a peace officer:

- A. Within 24 hours
- B. At the end of the guard's shift
- C. After completing an incident report
- ✓ D. Without unnecessary delay

D

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Module 4 — Security vs. Law Enforcement

PC §847

When a police officer accepts custody from a guard who made a citizen's arrest, who is legally the arresting party?

- A. The police officer
- B. Both equally
- C. The property owner
- ✓ D. The security guard — the private person

D

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Module 4 — Security vs. Law Enforcement

BPC §7582.1

California security guards are classified under the law as:

- A. Peace officers with limited jurisdiction
- C. Federal contractors

- ✓ B. Private persons — no additional authority from their badge or license
- D. Agents of the property owner with police powers on private property

B

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Module 5 — Liability

PC §236

False imprisonment under California Penal Code §236 is defined as:

- A. Arresting someone for a misdemeanor
- ✓ C. The unlawful violation of the personal liberty of another

- B. Detaining someone for more than one hour
- D. Any physical contact with a detained person

C

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Module 5 — Liability

PC §207

If a security guard unlawfully detains someone AND moves them to another location, the charge could escalate to:

- A. Disorderly conduct
- ✓ C. Kidnapping under PC §207

- B. Assault
- D. Trespassing

C

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Module 5 — Liability

BPC §480

A guard who makes an unlawful arrest could face BSIS consequences including:

A. A written warning only

✓ B. Guard card suspension or revocation under BPC §480

C. Mandatory additional training only

D. No regulatory consequences

B

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Module 5 — Liability

Vicarious Liability

MACCESS INC. as the PPO may be held liable for a guard's wrongful arrest under the doctrine of:

A. Strict product liability

B. Qualified immunity

✓ C. Vicarious liability

D. Contributory negligence

C

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Module 5 — Liability

PC §242

A guard uses excessive force during a detention. Which charge most directly applies?

A. Trespassing

✓ B. Battery under PC §242

C. Vandalism

D. Disturbing the peace

B

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Module 5 — Liability

BPC §7583.2

BSIS must be notified when a guard is involved in use-of-force incidents per:

A. PC §837

B. Title 16 CCR §600

✓ **C. BPC §7583.2**

D. PC §242

C

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Module 6 — Trespass & Property Law

PC §602

Under California Penal Code §602, trespass is generally classified as a:

A. Felony

B. Infraction only

C. Civil violation only

✓ **D. Misdemeanor**

D

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Module 6 — Trespass & Property Law

PC §602 | PC §837(1)

A person refuses to leave private property after a lawful order. An arrest may be lawful because:

A. The property owner requested it

B. Guards always have authority to arrest trespassers

✓ **C. The refusal constitutes a public offense in the guard's presence**

D. BSIS license authorizes this action

C

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Module 6 — Trespass & Property Law

Civil Rights Law

When removing someone from a public accommodation, a guard must have a reason that is:

- A. The same as on private property
- B. Written and signed by management
- ✓ C. Specific and legitimate — unrelated to any protected characteristic
- D. Approved by law enforcement in advance

C

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Module 6 — Trespass & Property Law

PC §602

For trespass on open land, what is generally required before detaining someone?

- A. A written judge's order
- B. A prior BSIS incident report
- C. Police authorization in writing
- ✓ D. Clear posting or fencing and a verbal warning

D

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Module 7 — Ethics, Communication & Documentation

Title 16 CCR §643(b)

Per Title 16 CCR §643(b), a Certificate of Completion must be issued by:

- A. BSIS directly
- B. The applicant's attorney
- C. The property owner
- ✓ D. The training entity or company providing the training

D

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Module 7 — Ethics, Communication & Documentation

BSIS PTA Manual §8

An incident report should be completed:

- A. At the end of the guard's shift
- B. The following business day
- C. Only when requested by a supervisor
- ✓ D. Within 1 hour of the incident

D

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Module 7 — Ethics, Communication & Documentation

BSIS Ethics Standards

A guard who falsifies an incident report may face:

- A. A verbal warning only
- B. A civil fine only
- C. No consequences if the incident was minor
- ✓ D. Termination and BSIS license revocation

D

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Module 7 — Ethics, Communication & Documentation

BSIS Ethics Standards

A guard's enforcement decisions must be free from bias based on:

- A. The guard's professional intuition
- B. Employer policies regardless of law
- ✓ C. Race, gender, appearance, or other protected characteristics
- D. The property owner's personal preferences

C

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Module 7 — Ethics, Communication & Documentation

BSIS PTA Manual §8

When announcing a citizen's arrest, a guard should:

- A. Remain silent to avoid legal exposure
- C. Only announce after police arrive

B. Wait for police to speak first

✓ **D. Clearly state the basis for the arrest in plain language****D**

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Module 7 — Ethics, Communication & Documentation

Title 16 CCR §643(b)

Training records must be maintained by the PPO and made available to BSIS:

A. For 6 months

B. For 1 year

✓ **C. Upon request for the duration of employment**

D. For 5 years after termination

C

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Module 8 — Emergency Response & Officer Safety

BSIS PTA Manual §9

When discovering a medical emergency, a guard's FIRST action should be:

A. Notify their supervisor

B. Begin medical treatment immediately

✓ **C. Assess the scene for personal safety, then call 911**

D. Secure the area and wait for police

C

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Module 8 — Emergency Response & Officer Safety

DHS Run-Hide-Fight

In an active shooter situation, the recommended priority order is:

A. Hide, Fight, Run

B. Fight, Hide, Run

C. Call 911, Hide, Fight

✓ D. Run, Hide, Fight

D

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Module 8 — Emergency Response & Officer Safety

BSIS PTA Manual §10

Blood-borne pathogen precautions require a guard to:

A. Refuse all physical contact

B. Request a hazmat team

C. Document exposure only after the fact

✓ D. Wear gloves before any contact that may involve blood or bodily fluids

D

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Module 8 — Emergency Response & Officer Safety

BSIS PTA Manual §10

When law enforcement arrives at a scene where a guard made a citizen's arrest, the guard should:

A. Continue managing the situation until formally relieved

B. Announce their BSIS authority first

✓ C. Keep hands visible and follow all officer commands

D. Present their guard card first and speak first

C

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Module 8 — Emergency Response & Officer Safety

BSIS PTA Manual §10

Situational awareness means:

- A. Watching only the primary entry point
- C. Focusing on the most suspicious-looking individual

- ✓ B. Knowing your exits and continuously monitoring the environment for threats
- D. Staying stationary to observe from one position

B

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Module 9 — Knowledge Check & Exam Prep

PC §847

After a lawful citizen's arrest, how long may a guard hold the person before law enforcement must be contacted?

- A. Up to 4 hours
- C. Up to 24 hours if police are unavailable

- B. Until the end of the shift

- ✓ D. Without unnecessary delay — no extended holding permitted

D

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Module 9 — Knowledge Check & Exam Prep

PC §837 | PC §836

Which BEST distinguishes a guard's arrest authority from a police officer's?

- A. Guards can only arrest on weekdays
- C. Guards must have a supervisor present for all arrests

- B. Guards cannot use handcuffs under any circumstances
- ✓ D. Guards cannot arrest based on probable cause developed through their own investigation

D

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Module 9 — Knowledge Check & Exam Prep

PC §837(1) | PC §602

A guard observes shoplifting in real time. The person drops the item and tries to leave. Best action?

A. Physically tackle the person to prevent escape

B. Follow into the parking lot and arrest there

C. Take no action — only managers can stop shoplifters

✓ D. Detain on property with reasonable force and immediately call

D

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Module 9 — Knowledge Check & Exam Prep

PC §837 | BPC §7583.7

A security guard may NEVER make a citizen's arrest for a misdemeanor if:

A. The offense occurred on private property

B. The person is not a repeat offender

✓ C. The guard did not personally witness the offense

D. The offense occurred after business hours

C

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Module 9 — Knowledge Check & Exam Prep

BPC §7583.7

MACCESS INC.'s California Private Patrol Operator license number is:

A. #112233

B. #100001

C. #133445

✓ D. #122729

D

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*Module 9 — Knowledge Check & Exam Prep**PC §847 | BSIS Training Standards*

A guard holds a subject for 2 hours without calling police after a citizen's arrest. They may face:

- A. No consequences if the arrest was lawful
- C. A supervisor review only

- ✓ **B. False imprisonment charges and BSIS disciplinary action**
- D. Praise for thorough documentation

B

SCORING GUIDE & LIVE SCAN READINESS

Passing Score

100% — all 55 questions correct required per BPC §7583.7

Scoring Method

1 point per correct answer. No partial credit. Full retake required if below passing score.

Certificate

Issue MACCESS INC. Certificate of Completion only to students achieving 100%. Sign and date each certificate.

Record Keeping

Retain each student's assessment record per Title 16 CCR §643(b). Records subject to BSIS audit at any time.

Answer Key Security

This document is for MACCESS INC. internal use only. Do not share with students before, during, or after the assessment.

PENDING — When BSIS Live Scan equipment is acquired, update LIVE_SCAN_CONFIG in the test script:

Live Scan — Status

- Set enabled: true
- Set bsisORI: [your DOJ-assigned ORI]
- Set atiPrefix: [your ATI prefix]
- Drop BSIS certificate template into PSLAW-Courses/live-scan/

Live Scan — Records

When active: each student's Live Scan receipt will be captured in the test module and submitted to the notificationEmail. Maintain all Live Scan ATI numbers alongside training records.